

“Drinking is the joy of the Rus. We cannot exist without that pleasure.”

VLADIMIR OF KIEV'S REPLY TO BULGAR MUSLIM ENVOYS SUGGESTING HE CONVERT, c. 987 CE

988 CE

BAPTISM OF VLADIMIR OF KIEV

The Grand Prince of Kiev was baptized in a ceremony at Kiev. He had reputedly sent envoys to neighbouring lands to investigate their religions, and found all but Greek Orthodox Christianity disagreeable. His baptism in the faith made possible an alliance with Byzantium through his marriage to Emperor Basil II's sister.



▽ Baptism of Prince Vladimir

970 CE

975 CE Byzantine Emperor

John Tzimiskes recaptures Damascus after a successful Syrian campaign

987 CE The Capetian dynasty

is founded in France by Hugh Capet, elected king after the death of the last Carolingian

973 CE Parantaka II defeats the Rashtrakutas, establishing the Chola dynasty's supremacy in south India

982 CE The Dai Viet kingdom destroys the Champa capital of Indrapura

985 CE

VIKINGS COLONIZE GREENLAND

After being exiled from Iceland for his involvement in a fatal brawl, Erik the Red sailed to a land that he named “Greenland” in order to attract more colonists. He was followed by thousands of migrants who established two settlements (the Eastern and Western) on the southern tip of the island; these survived for over 400 years.



▷ Erik the Red

987 CE

TOLTEC INFLUENCE REACHES THE YUCATAN

In the Maya city of Chichen Itzá, the appearance of Toltec-style architecture from Tula, including chacmool offering altars, Atlantean warrior statues, and the temple-pyramid of Kukulcán, suggest the movement of people from central Mexico to the Yucatán Peninsula. It is not clear whether these people came as invaders, settlers, or as a new elite, or if the local Maya rulers simply assimilated Toltec culture.



△ Toltec warrior statue